

1950, February 11

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

SAINT FELIX FRIARY  
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA+

February 11, 1950  
FEAST OF THE APPARITION OF  
OUR BLESSED MOTHER MARY  
AT LOURDES+

Dear Sister Mary Constance:-

God bless you this happy feast of our dear blessed Mother Mary; Queen of Lourdes, Queen of Mercy, Queen of the Universe and of the Most Holy Trinity. It is really time to retire, but I must at least start with a few words to you before this date is gone, - even though it be as yet only a "duplex."

I received your letter of Wednesday last evening and, as much as time would permit, have studied it since. I want to go into some details in response to it but can not do so just now. In general, however, I must say that I am greatly encouraged at its upright tone and the good will it indicates all around, - an example of patient forbearance and of gentle readiness to relent in charity.

15th 9:30 P.M. -A late start again. God Help us! It just seems that I get nowhere; and yet so many things I ought to be doing. Glory be to God! I did remember you in my holy Mass this morning and blessed you at the end. In fact your request for Tonight's "break" has been pretty well on my mind since Saturday, and in my prayers. I trust you had a favorable experience rather than any serious embarrassment, - both for yourself and your teeners, ... etc. This, however, excluding whatever might check anyone's already too weak tendency to love the really life-giving humiliations that so often gently lead us to love Jesus more, and to follow Him.

But dear Sister, how fortunate you are after all now, under such circumstances as are yours, without realizing it! How fortunate in having a Rev. Mother at once so decided and yet so condescending! Surely you ought to keep in close touch with her and inform her about everything that transpires as affecting this, your so really threatening and fearful experience; - an experience that I for one, have not the least doubt is - for your final "doing or undoing", for time as well as for eternity. ...